to let their defenders get forward in open play. We knew we had the players to hit them back on the counterattack. Our concentration seemed excellent and, although they had a couple of early chances—Dave Seaman had to save one Roberto Carlos free-kick—there wasn't anything going on to worry us.

Don't make mistakes. Wait for the other lot to make theirs. There were just over twenty minutes gone when Brazil lost possession in our third of the field. Emile Heskey got the ball on halfway and, ahead of him, he saw Michael starting to make a run across his defender. Emile hit his pass thirty-odd yards towards the corner of the Brazilian penalty area. It looked as if the central defender, Lucio, would bring the ball down and clear. I don't know if he caught sight of Michael and was half-worried about a challenge, but Lucio definitely took his eye off the ball. Instead of controlling it, he let it bounce down and away from him into Michael's path. Great strikers don't stand still. They're already moving, expecting to get their chance before anyone else sees there's anything on. Michael pushed the ball away and ran into the box. You knew, groin injury or not, Michael was never going to be caught once he was through. And because he'd been surprised by what happened, the keeper, Marcos, didn't come off his line until it was too late. Michael just had to steady himself and dink his shot beyond the keeper and into the far corner. One-nil. I was forty yards away. It was like watching it on television. *Michael Owen's scoring for England against Brazil. I don't believe this is happening. I hope the video's recording.*

If it had remained 1–0 at half-time, I genuinely believe England might have won the World Cup. But Brazil are some team. Never mind the ability: they're completely fearless with it. Being a goal down didn't throw them out of their stride at all. Nothing was going to change their approach to the game. With any team other than Brazil, if you get a lead, you expect it to force your opponents to push forwards and start taking risks. Not them, though: they're the best in the world and they know it; and that's the way they play every game anyway.

About five minutes before the end of the half, Roberto Carlos had a shot which took a deflection. Dave Seaman jumped to catch the ball and hurt his neck, falling backwards. It didn't look good. There was a chance he'd have to go off. I looked away from Dave and the trainer, Gary Lewin, for a moment. Ronaldo was standing with the referee, Ramos Rizo, talking about something. And then he started laughing and put his arm round Rizo's shoulder. He looked like this was him and a few mates enjoying a Wednesday night kickabout down at the local park, without a care in the world. *How can you be doing that, 1–0 down at the World Cup? This isn't over. This isn't anywhere*